

THE INTERN DIARIES

Intern Report

Executive KPI Dashboard

WEEK 4 | DAILY JOURNAL ENTRY



LEARNING BY DOING, ONE DAY AT A TIME

Sample Superstore (RETAIL COMMERCE)

1. What KPIs were included in the executive dashboard and why were they selected?

Answer: The dashboard focuses on five key KPIs: **Total Revenue, Total Profit, Profit Margin, Total Orders, and Total Customers**. These metrics were selected because they provide a concise view of overall business performance, covering revenue generation, profitability, profitability efficiency, transaction activity, and customer reach. Limiting the KPI count helps keep the dashboard suitable for management use without overwhelming the user with too many metrics.

2. How was the Total Orders KPI calculated accurately?

Answer: The **Total Orders** KPI was calculated using **DISTINCTCOUNT(Order ID)** rather than simply counting rows in the dataset. This is important because a single order can contain multiple products and therefore appear across multiple transaction rows. Using distinct Order IDs ensures that each order is counted only once and prevents the KPI from overstating the actual number of orders.

3. How was the revenue trend and previous-year comparison implemented?

Answer: A dedicated **DimDate** table was created using the minimum and maximum Order Date values, with additional fields such as **Year, Month, Quarter, YearMonth, and YearMonthSort**. The YearMonth field was sorted using YearMonthSort to maintain chronological order, and the **Revenue LY** measure used **SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR()** to compare current revenue with the corresponding period from the previous year. This allowed the dashboard to present both the current revenue trend and historical year-over-year context in a single visual.

4. How do dynamic filters improve the usefulness of the dashboard?

Answer: Dynamic slicers for **Order Date, Region, Category, and Segment** allow users to interactively change the scope of the dashboard without creating separate reports for each business area. When a filter is selected, the KPI cards and supporting visuals can update to reflect the selected segment of the data, making it easier to investigate performance across different periods, regions, product categories, and customer segments while keeping the dashboard on a single page.

5. How was clutter avoided while designing the executive dashboard?

Answer: Clutter was controlled by limiting the number of KPIs, using only a few business-focused visuals, avoiding unnecessary transaction-level tables, and maintaining a clear visual hierarchy. The dashboard **prioritizes the most important information first through KPI cards**, followed by the revenue trend and selected business breakdowns such as **category, region, and top products**. This approach keeps the report concise and focused on information that supports management-level understanding rather than displaying every available field or metric.